MOOD OF THE NATION POLL

A Vote for Stability

There is a significant metric that explains the boost in the ruling party's electoral standing. For the first time, 'political stability' has emerged as the single-biggest achievement of the Modi-led NDA government, displacing 'construction of the Ram Temple at Ayodhya' and the 'revocation of Article 370', which have been the toppers in past MOTNs. Infrastructure development and a corruption-free government also figure in the list of the government's top five achievements. Among the reasons why the respondents put political stability ahead is the fractured state of the Opposition, which inspires little confidence.

POLITICAL STABILITY, A MAJORITY OF THE RESPONDENTS BELIEVE, HELPED INDIA TACKLE ITS FOREIGN POLICY TRILEMMA IN 2025, FROM A MERCURIAL TRUMP, A HOSTILE PAKISTAN TO A BLOW HOT, BLOW COLD CHINA

They believe that the political stability Modi has brought has helped India deal decisively with the trilemma of its foreign policy in 2025. This included an aggressive Trump, a hostile Pakistan and Bangladesh, and a China blowing hot and cold. In the face of these provocations, most respondents believe that NDA foreign policy was robust in improving India's global standing. A majority believe that Indo-US ties have worsened with Trump's return, but are clear that Modi should give as good as he gets from the US president. More than 45 per cent want the prime minister to retaliate with reciprocal tariffs, though 33.6 per cent want him to take measures to offset the negative impact on Indian industry. On relation-

Q. What do you believe is the primary motive behind the government's decision to replace MGNREGA with VB-G RAM G?

- Improve the programme — 34
- Political branding of 'RAM', aligning with Hindutva ideology — 26
- Remove Mahatma Gandhi's name — 15
- Dilute benefits — 8

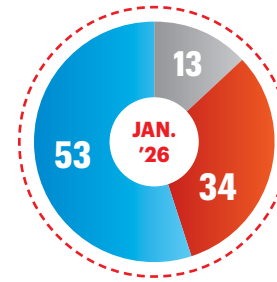
Rest, DK/ CS

Q. The BJP attracts a far larger share of corporate political funding than its rivals. Do you think the BJP, as the ruling party, gets unfair advantage in elections?

- Yes, the ruling party is always at an advantage — 48
- No, funding should remain the choice of the donors — 19
- No, the party with a higher likelihood of winning gets more donations — 17

Rest, DK/ CS

Q. In November 2025, the Department of Telecommunications directed smartphone manufacturers to pre-instal the government cybersecurity app Sanchar Saathi on new devices as an anti-fraud measure. Although the government later clarified that installation was not mandatory, what is your view on such a mandate?



- It's a good idea as a pre-installed security app will help combat cybercrime and protect users
- It's a bad idea as it raises privacy concerns and users should choose what to install on their phones
- DK/ CS

SANCHAR SAATHI

Q. A Constitution Amendment Bill (130th) was introduced in Aug. 2025 to remove any prime minister/ chief minister/ minister from office if arrested and held in custody for 30 days on serious charges. Do you agree with this proposed amendment?



- Yes, leaders accused of serious crimes should vacate office if jailed for a month
- No, a mere arrest shouldn't cost an elected leader their position before conviction

Rest, DK/ CS

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say